

Literature • Realistic

Grade	1	Word Count	181
Lexile	370L	Multi-level	N/A
Learning A–Z	level G		

Refer to the Focus Question on page 2 of this title to guide discussion and support additional learning connected to the text.

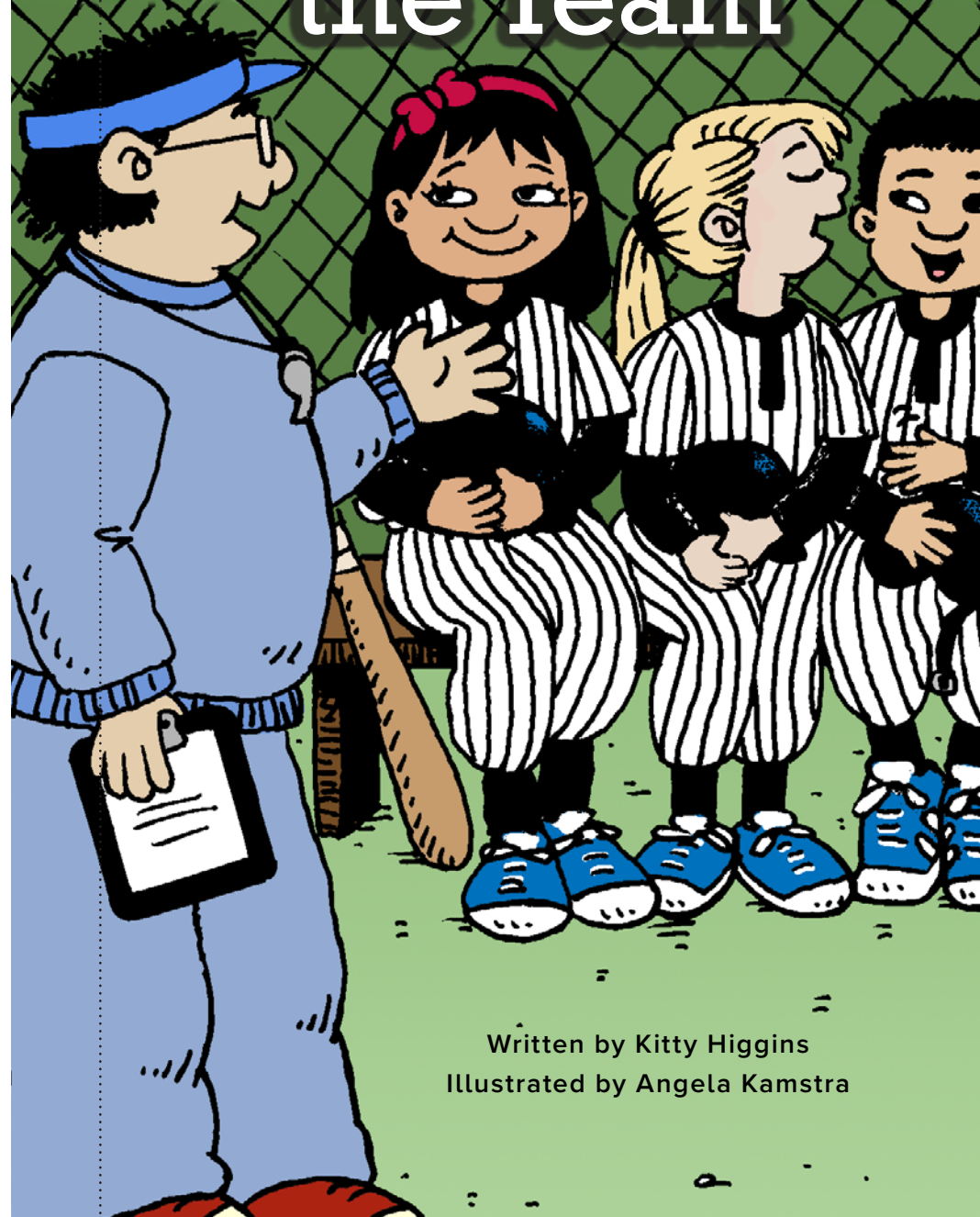
In this story, Maria is excited about joining a baseball team until she discovers that her friend's birthday party conflicts with a baseball game. Will she let down her team or her friend? This book is part of the Maria series.


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Maria Joins the Team



Written by Kitty Higgins
Illustrated by Angela Kamstra

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Focus Question

What is Maria's problem in the story, and how is it solved?





Maria likes to play baseball.
She plays catch with her
brother, Luis.



“The baseball coach asks Maria
to join the baseball team.
“We play at four o’clock
on Tuesdays,” he says.



“Mom, I really want to play,”
Maria says. “Can I?”
Maria’s mom says yes, and
they race home to tell her dad.



Maria wears her baseball mitt
to bed the night before her
first game.
She gets up to go to school,
and her mitt is still on.



At school, Amos gives Maria a note.
The note asks her to come to his birthday party.



“Oh, no! I can’t come,”
Maria says.
“I have a big game that day.”
“Maybe I could come to your party instead.”



Maria asks the coach that night.
“You can miss the game,” he says.
“But the team will not have
a shortstop.”



“I should not miss the game,”
Maria says.
“The team needs me.”



It is the day of the big game.
All of Maria's family comes
to watch.



After the game, Amos comes
to give Maria a balloon.
He brings her cake, too!